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Argentina's Milei Visits Rebbe's Ohel, Grave of Chabad Leader, in New York, Reaffirms Strong Support for Israel



by Ailin Vilches Arguello



Argentine President Javier Milei speaks during a Plenum session of the Knesset, Israel's Parliament, in Jerusalem, June 11, 2025. Photo: REUTERS/Ronen Zvulun

Argentina's President Javier Milei visited the Rebbe's Ohel, the resting place of Chabad-Lubavitch leader Rabbi Menachem Mendel Schneerson, in Queens, New York on Sunday during his US diplomatic tour, reaffirming his strong support for Israel and solidarity with the Jewish community amid rising Middle East tensions.

Alongside Rabbi Simon Jacobson, chairman and publisher of *The Algemeiner*, the Argentine president visited the mausoleum of the world-renowned Jewish thinker and spiritual leader.

Over the years, the site has drawn not only devoted Jewish pilgrims but also leaders and public figures from around the world seeking guidance, inspiration, and a moment of reflection.

Milei's visit to the Ohel marked his first stop in New York, a spiritually significant and politically symbolic gesture that comes amid surging antisemitism around the world and ongoing conflict in the Middle East, where the US and Israel continue to wage a military campaign against Iran.

Together with Foreign Secretary Pablo Quirno, Chief of Staff Manuel Adorni, and Secretary General of the Presidency Karina Milei, the Argentine leader began his diplomatic tour in Miami earlier this week, marking his 15th visit to the United States.

Organized by the Argentine Embassy as part of Argentina Week, in partnership with Bank of America and J.P. Morgan, this latest tour aims to strengthen diplomatic ties with allied leaders while attracting new investment to Buenos Aires.

On Saturday, Milei participated in the "Shields of the Americas" summit in Miami, which brought together political leaders and business figures from across the continent.

He also attended a luncheon hosted by US President Donald Trump and was honored with an award at the Hispanic Prosperity Gala.

While in New York, Milei spoke at Yeshiva University in Manhattan, delivering a speech that underscored his commitment to fighting terrorism and promoting stronger international cooperation.

“I feel like the most Zionist president in the world,” the Argentine leader said during his speech.

He also reaffirmed his support for Israel and the United States amid the current escalation in the war with Iran, declaring, “We are going to win.”

Since the start of the war, Milei has voiced strong backing for the US and Israel’s military campaign against Iran. At the same time, his government has heightened security alerts amid growing concerns that Iran and its terrorist proxies could activate sleeper cells abroad in retaliation.

While in New York, he is also set to attend *The Algemeiner’s* annual gala, where on Monday he will be honored for his “unwavering moral clarity, principled leadership, and steadfast support for Israel and the Jewish people.”

Milei will conclude his tour with a visit to Chile to attend the presidential inauguration of newly elected president José Antonio Kast.

Since taking office over a year ago, Milei has been one of Israel’s most vocal supporters, strengthening bilateral relations to unprecedented levels and in the process breaking with decades of Argentine foreign policy tradition to firmly align with Jerusalem and Washington.

Last year, Milei formally launched the Isaac Accords with the aim of strengthening political, economic, and cultural cooperation between the Jewish state and Latin American governments.

The Argentine leader called his country a “pioneer” alongside the United States in promoting the new framework, emphasizing its role in fostering closer ties between Israel and the region across key strategic fields.

Milei also announced plans to relocate the country’s embassy to Jerusalem next spring, fulfilling a promise made last year,

as the two allies continue to strengthen their bilateral ties.

Less than a year after the Hamas-led invasion of and massacre across southern Israel on Oct. 7, 2023, Argentina became the first Latin American country to designate the Palestinian Islamist group as a terrorist organization.

